

HAVE A QUESTION? THE ANSWER IS PROBABLY HERE.

This document is a resource guide for frequently asked questions. It is not designed to serve in place for the full SDC Constitution. It is the expectation that each SDC Organization familiarize itself with the SDC Constitution.



Budgets

Each student organization under SDC is allotted a sum of money to be distributed equally over two terms-Fall and Spring-that is in congruence with the organization's budget requests from the previous academic year. It is the responsibility of each student organization to maintain accurate and appropriate records of their spending. Student organizations should not depend on professional staff or the SDC Exec Board to know how much money it has.



Credit Card Policy

The SDC Credit Card policy is written into the SDC Constitution. It is the responsibility of each organization's treasurer to familiarize themselves with the credit card policy, to uphold it, and be held accountable to it. This includes but is not limited to: following the procedures of budget requests via SyncDin, card checkout, and receipt protocol. Each organization treasurer will have access to a shared Box to digitally catalog their organization's receipts. It is the requirement and expectation that all receipts be turned in digitally as soon as a purchase is made and the credit card is turned in no later than 24 hours after checkout.



Catering

Bon Appetit is the official on-campus food vendor and they offer a robust array of catering services. However, you are allowed to welcome off-campus food vendors on campus. This will most likely be in the form of food trucks. Any external food vendor must provide the following documents:

1. Proof of Insurance (must be current)
2. ServSafe Certificate
3. DHEC Rating (if applicable)

It is the responsibility of the student organization to coordinate these documents and provide them to CIC staff. CIC staff will then add the vendors to an external food vendors shared Box folder.

Bon Appetit's catering menu may be found here:

<https://furman.catertrax.com/menuGrid.asp?mode=c&cg=3&intCustomerID=&intOrderID=>



Chalking

Chalking is only allowed on exterior sidewalks or roads not commonly used for vehicular traffic. Chalking is only allowed to advertise specific events, can only occur one week prior to the event, and must be removed the day after the event. You are not allowed to chalk at the Joseph Vaughn Plaza.



Contracts

Student can never sign contracts on behalf of their student organizations. All contracts have to be looked over the university's legal department. Please give as much notice as you can to the department, minimally two weeks before the contract is due. All contracts must be submitted to OSIE via email.



Elections

Each organization under SDC is unique in how it elects officers, so it is critical that each student organization be familiar with its own practices and processes. SDC holds elections in the Spring term and for other organizations that follow suit, please note that elections must be completed by the third Wednesday in March so that officer transition is completed by the third Wednesday in April.



Event Registration

All organization-sponsored events/activities must be registered with the Office of Student Involvement and Engagement seven days in advance of the event. The only exceptions are regularly occurring business meetings, at which members only are present. Event registrations are to be submitted via SyncDin and must include all event logistics. Failure to register an event may result in its cancellation.



Facilities

Each student organization is expected to include coordinating with facilities in their event planning process. A student organization is expected to give at least seven (7) days notice of facilities needs to the facilities staff. These needs may include, but are not limited to: tables, chairs, tents, trashcans, electrical, etc. More complex needs should be coordinated in conjunction with OSIE and CIC staff as a part of the event planning process. More complex needs may include but are not limited to: furniture rentals, lighting, fireworks, etc. Some events, like those involving fireworks, need to be planned at least 3 months in advance. OSIE and CIC staff are skilled and here for you, but they are not miracle workers. Forethought is the name of the game.

If student organizations are planning events where there is expected to be a large volume of trash, the organizations must order trashcans from facilities and coordinate taking the trash to the dump to minimize burden on facilities staff.

Facilities services do have a cost attached to them. Be sure to include this cost in your event budget proposal. You may ask facilities staff for a cost estimate.



Marketing Materials

Marketing materials include but are not limited to: flyers, social media posts, t-shirts, etc. It is the expectation that student organizations uphold a standard of high ethical behavior and to represent their student organizations appropriately. Advertisements of an event may not contain any reference to alcohol specials/discounts as specials/discounts are not allowed by the student organization policy.

It is an expectation that each student organization be responsible for marketing their events, but CIC staff will support organizations in this effort by coordinating event flyers on the CIC social media accounts through our team of student coordinators.

Flyers may be posted in residence halls and in the student center after approval from OSIE. Flyers must be submitted via SyncDin. Approval is not required to post flyers in academic buildings. You may email P2X@furman.edu to print flyers and have the cost charged to your student organization worktag. Student organizations are responsible accounting for the printing costs in their event planning process.



Meetings

Student organizations are expected to meet regularly to build group solidarity, offer leadership opportunities, and further the vision and goals of the student organization on campus and in the greater community. As such, meetings should not be held on an "as needed" basis. Holding meetings in this way does not encourage involvement in the organization or help recruit new, dynamic members. While there is no meeting frequency set forth in the student organization handbook, CIC staff encourages organizations to meet at least biweekly.



Protests and Demonstrations

Furman University respects the right of all members of the academic community to explore and discuss questions and concerns which interest them and to join together to demonstrate their concerns by orderly means. Please consult with CIC staff in advance of a demonstration to ensure you are provided with the appropriate resources.



Room Reservations

To use a room in the Trone Student Center, a reservation request must be made via the Trone Reservation form on SyncDin. You must submit all requests for room usage at least fourteen (14) days prior to the event/meeting. Use 25Live to make a request for an academic building. Daniel Chapel, Daniel Recital Hall, and McAlister auditorium follow different reservation protocols. CIC Staff expects all student organizations to be mindful of our custodial staff. Just because there is not a formal reservation does not mean that the room is open for use. If you want to use a space, reserve it. Once you've reserved the space, honor the end time of the reservation. Our custodial staff must clean after every reservation and flip the room for others to use. Do not create more work for them.



Sound Amplification

Be good neighbors to each other. Be mindful that the normal workday ends at 5pm so, when you are planning an event near an academic or office space, be mindful of how the volume of music or other amplified sound. Additionally, be mindful of sound of any event near a residence hall after 9pm on weekdays and 10pm on weekends. This includes sounds projected from a CIC or OSIE speaker or an outside vendor i.e. DJ/band.



Storage and Mail

Each student organization under SDC has access a storage block near the CIC and OSIE office spaces in Trone. OSIE staff will be able to help locate and provide access to the storage. Please note that CIC offices and general lounge areas are not storage units and any items left in the space need to be removed without warning from CIC staff. Each student organization has access to mail slots in the Student Organization Commons to receive campus and external mail. Contact OSIE staff for access to a mail slot.



Vendor Payments

There are two ways vendors can be paid: via credit card or via university check.

Payment via credit card:

- Student organizations must complete the budget request form in SyncDin to access the credit card. Refer to the SDC Credit Card policy for more information. Student organizations must have an approved budget request before activating the credit card checkout process.
- Invoices are super easy to pay online. Please forward all online invoices to CIC staff and they will handle payment so student organizations do not have to activate the credit card checkout process.
- Invoices from PayPal or Square are acceptable. Money requests from PayPal or Square are unacceptable.
- The credit card information may never be placed into an individual's CashApp, Venmo, or PayPal to submit payment to a vendor.

Payment via university check:

- The vendor must provide an invoice and W9 paperwork. If the vendor does not have W9 paperwork, a blank W9 form can be provided to them. Student organizations and/or individual students may not fill out the W9 form for the vendor. Student organizations and/or individual students may not create an invoice without express written consent of CIC staff.
- Expect no less than one week for a university check to be mailed. CIC and OSIE staff do not process these in our offices.
- The university check will be mailed to the address on the invoice NOT the W9, so please be sure to communicate this to the vendor when they submit the paperwork.